Federation Square · research summary

Civic ground over rail: cultural institutions, covered passage and varied public life form an urban precinct.

Location / period

Melbourne · 2002

Architecture / landscape

LAB + Bates Smart / Karres en Brands

Area boundaries

Plaza 7,500 m²; Bates Smart project 44,000 m²

Evidence state

Published original drawings + official 2020 GIS + institutional photo archive



FED-GIS True figure-ground: official 2020 building footprints
907 ground/podium structure records; bridges excluded. Black is structure; white includes water, rail and unclassified space, not guaranteed walkability. Red circle is a location marker.
City of Melbourne; SVG processing by THE GREAT PLACES · City of Melbourne · Original source · Captured May 2020; retrieved 2026-11-13 · CC BY 4.0 · Attribution retained; filtering, projection and SVG conversion disclosed

Principal reading: ground, entrances, passage and operations jointly shape civic space. Multiple uses are documented; flow, capacity, thermal comfort and syntax metrics are not inferred from photos.

> Limits: 2020 footprints are not a 2026 survey; published sections have no calibrated scale; complete orthographic elevations, formal syntax computation and independent observations remain unavailable.

7,500 m² source: Karres en Brands · 44,000 m² source: Bates Smart · Figure-ground data: City of Melbourne · CC BY · Complete audit and sources